



MIT AI Risk
Initiative

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Technology

Introducing the AI Risk Navigator

An Exploration Tool for the AI Risk Initiative

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Executive Summary

What we built

- We built the [MIT AI Risk Navigator](#), an interactive web tool that centralizes the MIT AI Risk Initiative's datasets using shared taxonomies, enabling accessible, in-depth, and cross-dataset exploration for the first time.
- Version 1 is now available at [airi-navigator.com](#), with three new datasets currently in development for future integration.
- We created new interactive visualizations using the Navigator's scaffolding to replace existing Airtable charts on the main website.

What it enables

- Researchers can navigate any risk domain or subdomain and immediately see relevant risks, incidents, and governance documents side-by-side.
- The Navigator surfaces cross-dataset patterns that are invisible when datasets are viewed in isolation.
- All visualizations support PNG export, allowing for easy integration of AIRI's findings into presentations and reports.

What's next

- We welcome [feedback](#) on version 1 of the Navigator by June 1, 2026.
- Planned improvements include integration of additional datasets, expanded cross-dataset analysis tools, quality-of-life improvements, and deeper embedding support for the AIRI website.

[Feedback](#)

[Expressions of interest](#)

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Introducing the AI Risk Navigator

MIT's AI Risk Initiative (AIRI) maintains some of the most comprehensive datasets on AI risk available anywhere — thousands of catalogued risks from the academic literature, documented real-world AI incidents, governance documents from around the world, and concrete mitigation actions drawn from leading frameworks. The challenge is that these datasets have always existed in isolation from one another, and are inaccessible to a casual audience. Exploring any one of them meant losing sight of the rest.

Over the past several months, I have been working to fix that tension by building the [AI Risk Navigator](#) as part of my fellowship with the [Cambridge Boston Alignment Initiative](#). It is a purpose-built interface that centralizes all of AIRI's current datasets to let researchers, policymakers, and practitioners navigate the AI risk landscape as one interconnected body of knowledge.

This post introduces version 1 of the Navigator, walks through its core features, and outlines what is planned for future releases. I would welcome feedback and suggestions via [this form](#).

Background and motivation

My goal in creating the Navigator was twofold.

The first was accessibility. As a previous user of AIRI's data myself, I had encountered the friction that newcomers face when trying to access and navigate the datasets. AIRI's work is genuinely valuable — but raw Airtable interfaces, separate URLs for each dataset, and no shared navigation layer meant that making use of them required patience and prior familiarity. I wanted to lower that barrier and make the data accessible to a broader audience.

The second was interoperability. AIRI's datasets were developed independently, and while each is rigorous and well-maintained, there was no systematic way to move between them. Shared taxonomies, particularly the [Risk Domain Taxonomy](#), offered an underexploited opportunity. If multiple datasets could be mapped onto the same classification structure, users could move fluidly between them — from a risk identified in the academic literature, to incidents where it has materialized, to the governance frameworks addressing it. This kind of interoperability would also encourage cross-dataset analysis.

Achieving both goals required navigating several constraints. The independent nature of the datasets means each carries methodological limitations that restrict how directly they can be compared — incidents are each classified under a single risk domain despite often spanning several; governance data skews toward U.S. sources and may not accurately represent global AI governance in aggregate. Rather than papering over these limitations,

the Navigator is designed around them — selective about what cross-dataset comparisons it surfaces, and transparent about what the data can and cannot support.

Who is this for?

AIRI's datasets are individually valuable, but their real power lies in what they reveal when connected. The Navigator uses AIRI's risk domain taxonomy as a shared backbone — pick a subdomain, and you can immediately see the academic risk landscape, the real-world incident record, and the governance response in one place. This is a valuable tool for a variety of users:

- **Policymakers and regulators** can see how existing governance documents address specific risk domains, compare coverage against the incident record and available mitigations, and use subdomain detail pages to scope a risk area before drafting policy.
- **Researchers** can explore the gap between how risks are characterized in the academic literature and where real-world harms are actually occurring — for instance, which risk domains have extensive academic coverage but few documented incidents, and vice versa.
- **Risk evaluators and auditors** can quickly identify relevant risks, incidents, and governance requirements for a given domain, and pull targeted evidence into assessments and reports using filterable views and per-chart export.
- **Industry practitioners** can assess their exposure against AIRI's taxonomy, benchmark against the incident record, and identify which governance frameworks apply to their risk areas — all from a single interface rather than across four separate databases.

The Navigator is now publicly available at airi-navigator.com. Below, we walk through some of its key features.

Features

Navigating by taxonomy

The central design decision in the Navigator was making AIRI's risk domain taxonomy the primary entry point, rather than any individual dataset. The taxonomy — 7 domains spanning discrimination, privacy, misinformation, malicious use, human-computer interaction, socioeconomic harms, and AI system safety, broken into 24 more specific subdomains — gives every dataset a shared classification structure. A user can identify any corner of the AI risk landscape and immediately see what the academic literature says, what has actually happened, and what governance exists.

The taxonomy grid on the homepage serves as the primary entry point — click any domain or subdomain to start exploring.

The [dedicated taxonomy page](#) provides a full interactive reference for the classification structure, including definitions for every domain and the causal dimensions — entity, intent, and timing — that cut across the risk and incident datasets.

Discrimination & Toxicity 216 risks · 237 incidents 552 gov docs	Unfair discrimination and misrepresentation	Exposure to toxic content	Unequal performance across groups
Privacy & Security 192 risks · 102 incidents 901 gov docs	Compromise of privacy by leaking or correctly inferring sensitive information	AI system security vulnerabilities and attacks	
Misinformation 75 risks · 178 incidents 333 gov docs	False or misleading information	Pollution of information ecosystem and loss of consensus reality	
Malicious Actors & Misuse 243 risks · 491 incidents 771 gov docs	Disinformation, surveillance, and influence at scale	Cyberattacks, weapon development or use, and mass harm	Fraud, scams, and targeted manipulation
Human-Computer Interaction 106 risks · 35 incidents 408 gov docs	Overreliance and unsafe use	Loss of human agency and autonomy	
Socioeconomic & Environmental 278 risks · 23 incidents 1040 gov docs	Power centralization and unfair distribution of benefits	Increased inequality and decline in employment quality	Economic and cultural devaluation of human effort
	Competitive dynamics	Governance failure	Environmental harm
AI System Safety, Failures & Limitations 401 risks · 300 incidents 1141 gov docs	AI pursuing its own goals in conflict with human goals or values	AI possessing dangerous capabilities	Lack of capability or robustness
	Lack of transparency or interpretability	AI welfare and rights	Multi-agent risks

Figure 1: AI Risk Domain Taxonomy visualization.

Risk domain detail pages

Each of the risk domains and subdomains have their own [detail pages](#) that bring together data from across AIRI's datasets in a single view. Rather than navigating four separate databases and mentally connecting what you find, you can arrive at a subdomain page and the relevant data is already assembled. Each page contains information about the subdomain, findings from the datasets, and visuals to understand how it's represented in the data.

Each subdomain page opens with a definition and a few top findings, then pulls together the relevant slice of each dataset. Users can copy a brief summary containing the definition and top-level findings. The page offers co-location rather than synthesis: the datasets side-by-side, with the connections between them left for the reader to draw.

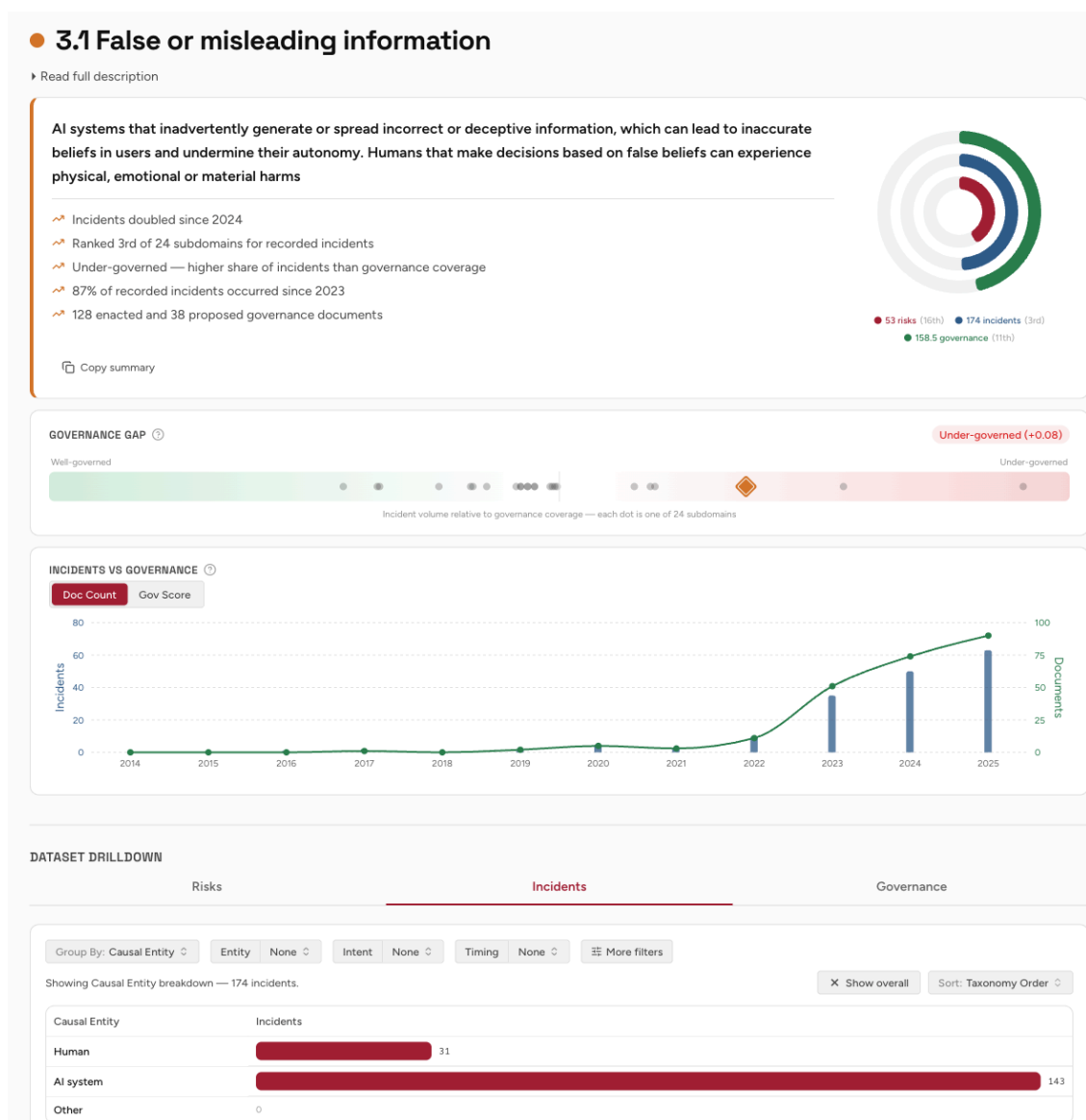


Figure 2: Subdomain detail page for 3.1 - False or Misleading Information.

Searching and browsing the data

Each dataset has its own browse page with filterable, card-based views. For example, you can find all [fraud-related incidents since 2012](#), or [defunct state-level regulations that addressed bias](#). Selecting an item will open a modal with more details, from which you can open a page that contains all of the data AIRI has on a given incident, risk, or governance document.

The Navigator also includes a global search with semantic and keyword matching, enabling queries across all datasets, taxonomies, and definitions simultaneously. Searching “autonomous vehicles” or “facial recognition” returns all relevant information together in a single view.

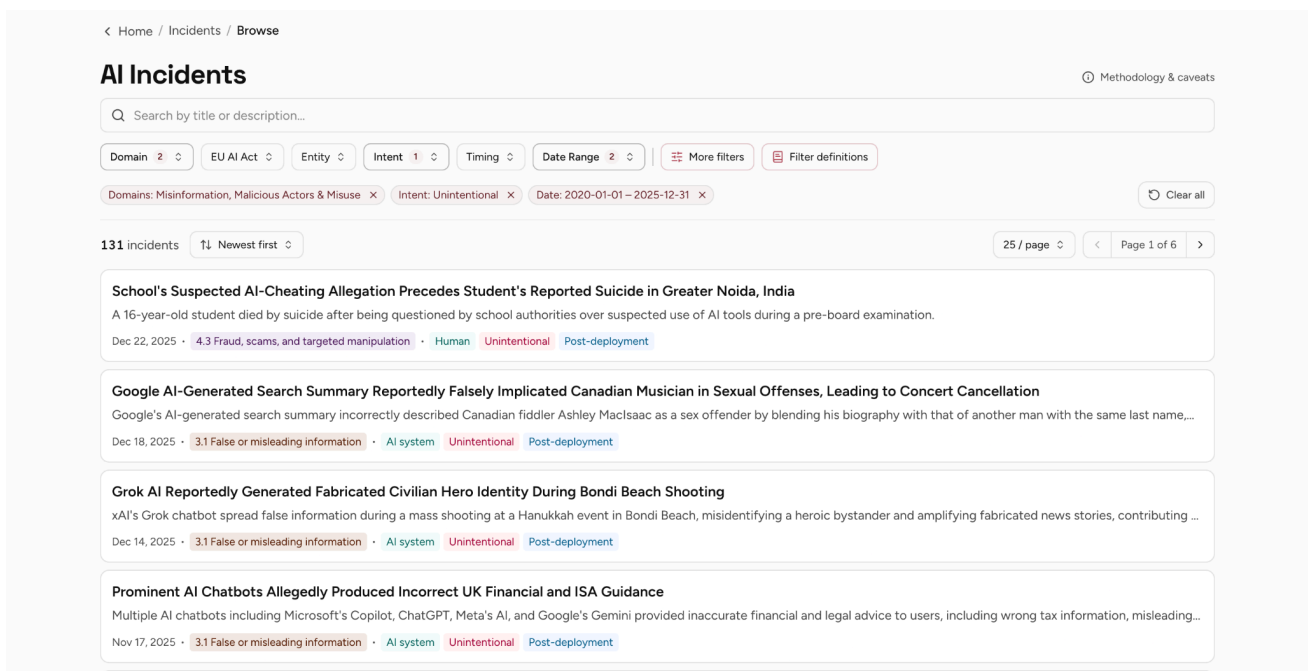


Figure 3: Example of filtered search results for incidents.

Dataset visualizations

Each dataset has its [own collection of visualizations](#) providing a higher-level view of structure and distribution — how risks are spread across the taxonomy, where incidents cluster, which domains have the most or least governance coverage.

These complement the record-level browsing and search, giving users a way to orient themselves before diving into individual records. All charts are available for download for use in external reports and presentations. These visualizations are also planned for integration into the main AIRI website.

Incident Breakdown

Grouped by AI System Purpose · Colored by Subdomain · Filtered: Entity = AI system | Intent = Unintentional

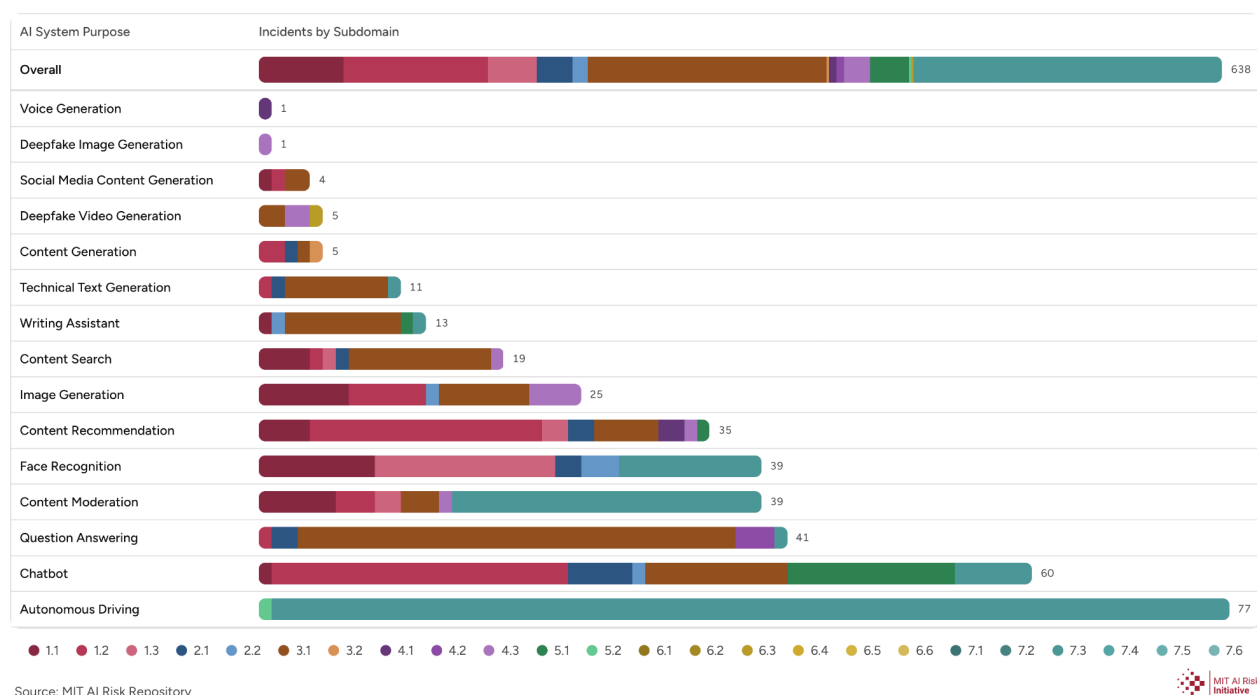


Figure 4: Exported version of the Incident Breakdown visualization.

Next steps

The Navigator is designed to grow with AIRI's data, and several priorities are already defined for future releases.

The most immediate is dataset expansion. AIRI currently has three new datasets in varying stages of completion, and as the catalog grows from four to seven over the coming months, the Navigator will integrate them as they are published. Each addition will enable cross-dataset analyses that are not yet possible with the current coverage.

On the quality-of-life side, dark mode, additional visualizations, and downloadable data with codebooks are in active development. Further ahead, I am exploring a systematic mapping between AIRI's risk and mitigation taxonomies — closing the loop from identifying a risk to understanding what concrete actions can reduce it. The Navigator may also act as a foundation for a new AIRI website and branding. Development will continue to be shaped by user feedback, which can be submitted via the [form here](#).

Questions for feedback

User feedback is crucial as we continue to refine and expand the Navigator. As this is an initial release, we are eager to receive feedback and suggestions from a wide range of users and use cases. While we welcome all comments, we are particularly eager to hear feedback on the following:

- Did you encounter any bugs, confusing UI elements, or anything not working as expected?
- Is the current structure the best way to navigate the data? Are there other approaches that would be better?
- Are the subdomain detail pages legible — is it clear what each panel is showing and why the data belongs together?
- What features are currently missing that would make the Navigator better suited for your use case?

Please leave any feedback [here](#) before June 1, 2026.

Acknowledgements

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